

he can use e-learning to communicate directly with his colleagues across continents. This helps employees on different schedules and in different time-zones to remain updated.

It is important to note that e-learning is not a replacement killer of traditional classroom-teaching, it is rather an enhancer. According to a two-year cross-industry study released in 2002 by Thomson Learning, e-learning-when used in a blended curriculum that also includes traditional classroom learning-is far more effective at driving employee productivity than classroom training alone.

While everybody agrees to the numerous benefits of e-learning, the cost effectiveness of the option is sometimes questionable. The technology involved and the infrastructure needed comes at an initial cost which would only prove beneficial to the company in the long run.

A few tangible benefits that can be attributed to e-learning are process improvements, increased customer satisfaction, increase in sales and revenues and improved communications - as well as a range of personal skill development in management, leadership, coaching and mentoring. Knowledge gained through e-learning is passed on beyond just the individual. It may be extended to a manager, a peer or a subordinate - thereby widening the application of the knowledge gained.



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The Benefits

A business embracing e-learning, sees a lot of difference in the expenditure pattern. It helps eliminate travel costs and decreases time away from the office for both students and trainers. The cost savings can be used to train more employees across the organisation.

E-learning helps provide targeted, efficient, just-in-time learning to employees at any time and at any location in the form of a Web-based desktop solution. Employees around the globe can collaborate online and discuss business needs and processes in real time.

E-learning can be customized to specific business processes to increase user adoption, minimize project risk, and ensure the organization has the skills and knowledge it needs to be successful.

Profiting From E-learning

Mahindra British Telecom (MBT) a joint venture between bluechip companies - Mahindra and Mahindra Ltd. India and British Telecommunications Plc. United Kingdom, uses e-learning extensively. Login2Learn is a product from MBT for managing e-Learning. MBT enables telecom companies protect their investments in legacy systems, enhance capital budgets, reduce operating expenses and helps them build solutions for the multi-services future. For a company with a workforce of more than 5,000, Login2Learn seemed like the best solution. Note that MBT uses Login2Learn only to impart training on technical skills; training on behavioural skills is still done the traditional way.

MBT's Login2Learn aims at removing the hurdles that prevent effective learning. Traditional, classroom-based training has to deal with many constraints including those of space, size of batches, and availability of both students and instructors. These constraints are eliminated when using Login2Learn to deliver Web-based training. It allows learners to actively manage their own training; by providing any time, any place, e-learning.

An e-learning system that incorporates self-learning complemented by suitable interaction with both the faculty and the

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